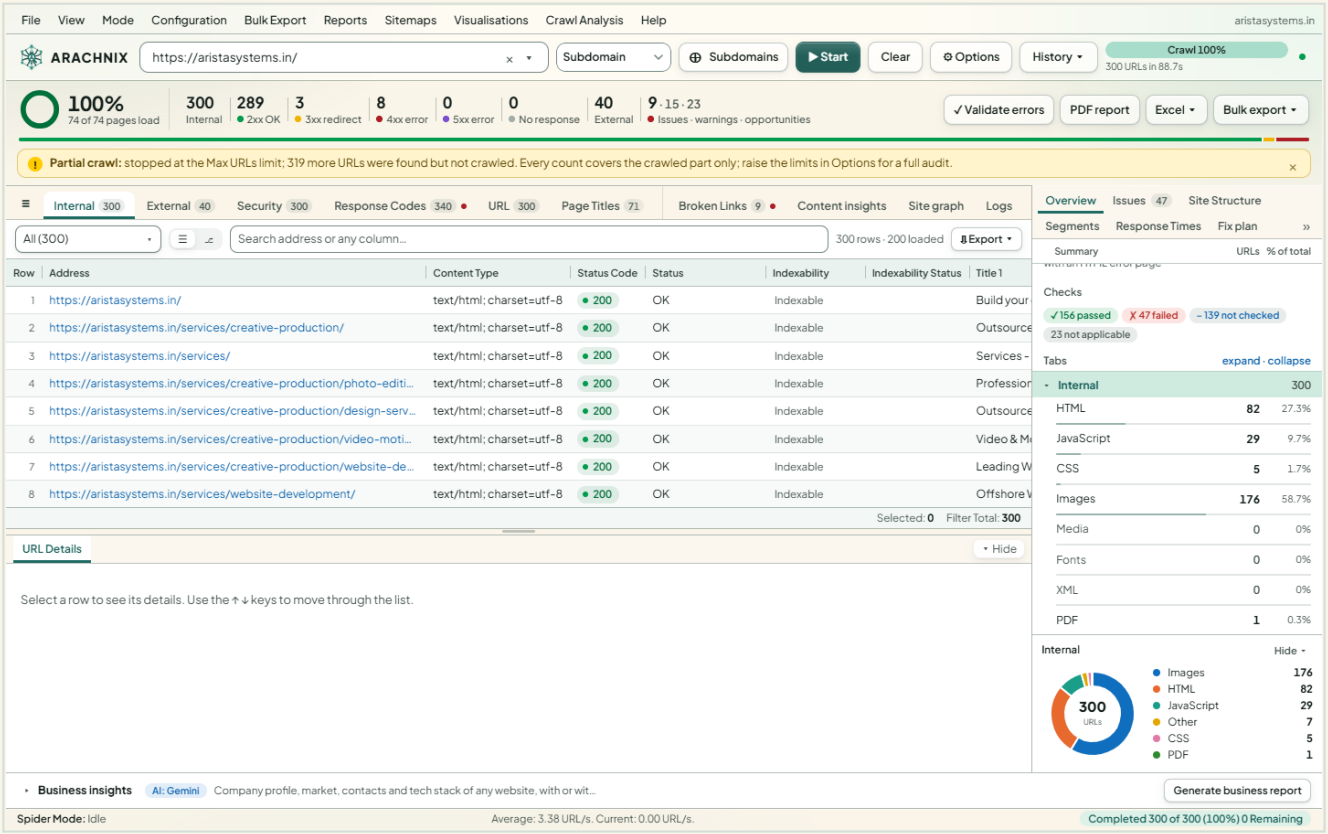
ARACHNIX

User Guide

version 1.0 · 28 October 2026

Run a crawl from start to finish: enter a site, read the results, find and fix issues, and share Excel and PDF reports. Every step shows the real screen.



Contents

How to read this guide The numbers in the orange circles on each screenshot match the numbered actions above it. Words in **bold** are the exact labels on the screen.

Getting started 3

1. Open ARACHNIX . . . 3

Run your first crawl 4

2. Enter the site and pick the mode . . . 4
3. Set the few options most people need . . . 4
4. Start the crawl and watch it run . . . 6

Read the results 7

5. The KPI strip and the Overview . . . 7
6. Tabs, filters and search . . . 8

Find and fix issues 9

7. The Issues panel . . . 9

The Fix plan: what to fix first . . . 10

Look at one URL 11

8. The URL details pane . . . 11

Visualise the site 13

9. Site graph and drill-down . . . 13

Crawl tree and other diagrams . . . 13

Compare crawls 14

10. Compare an earlier crawl with the crawl on screen . . . 14

Export and share 15

11. Excel, CSV and bulk exports . . . 15
12. PDF reports . . . 16

Saved crawls 18

13. Open, rename and manage saved crawls . . . 18

Settings: theme and glass 19

14. Theme and glass effects . . . 19

Help 20

15. The Help menu . . . 20

Quick reference 21

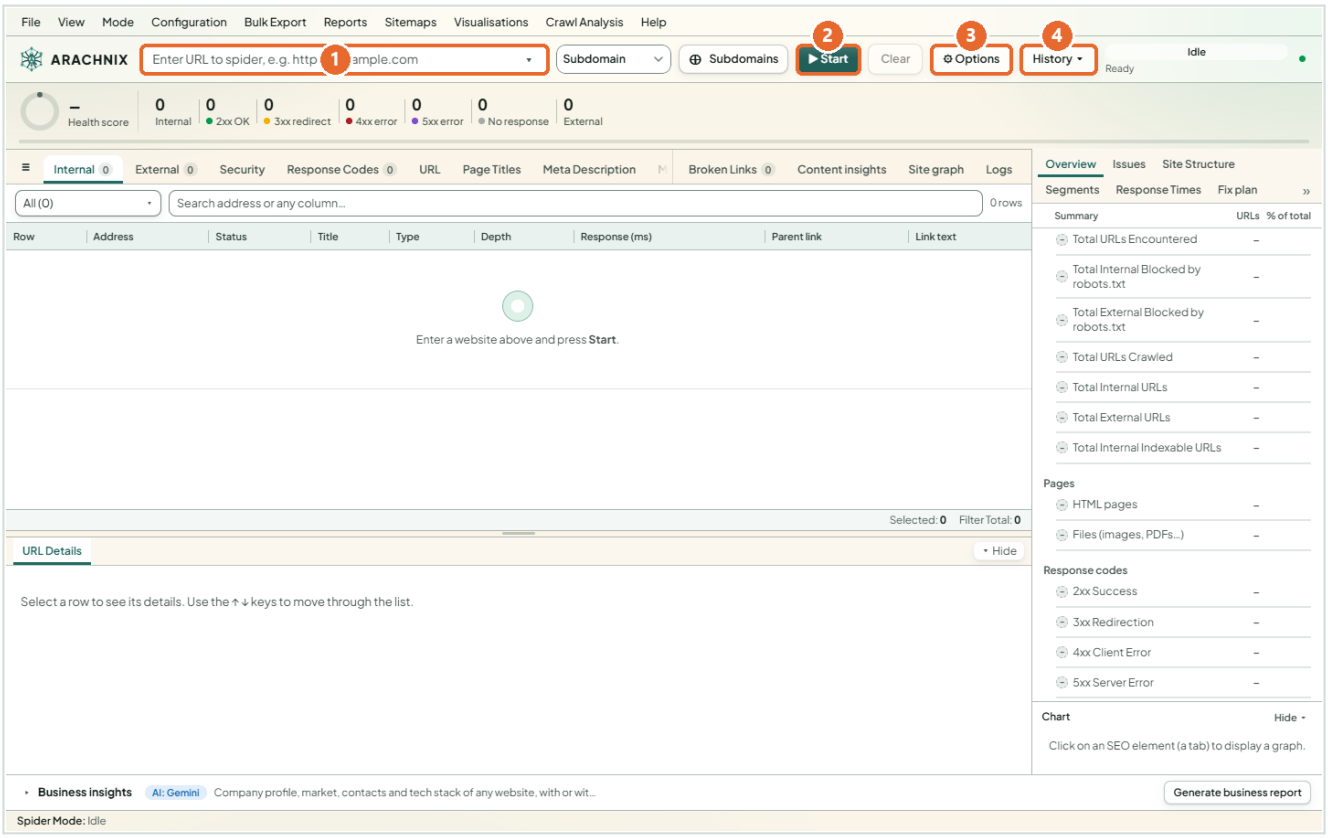
FAQ 22

Getting started

ARACHNIX is the team's SEO crawler. It visits a website the way Google does and lists every page, link, image and problem it finds. It runs on a team server: all you need is a browser.

1. Open ARACHNIX

1. Open the ARACHNIX address your team uses in Chrome or Edge (if the server asks for an access key, enter the key your admin gave you). The empty start screen has the address box **Enter URL to spider**.
2. **Start** runs the crawl.
3. **Options** holds the crawl settings.
4. **History** lists earlier crawls. The menu bar on top (**File**, **View**, **Mode**, **Configuration** … **Help**) has everything else.



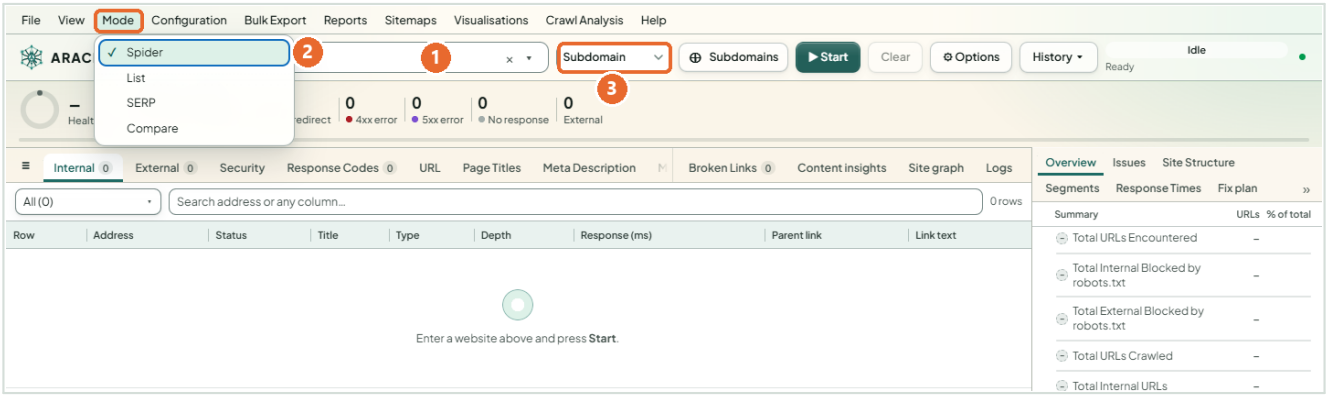
Tip The status at the top right says **Ready** when the server is free. The whole team uses the same server, so the crawl on screen is shared.

Run your first crawl

Three choices: the site, the mode and a few options. Then press Start.

2. Enter the site and pick the mode

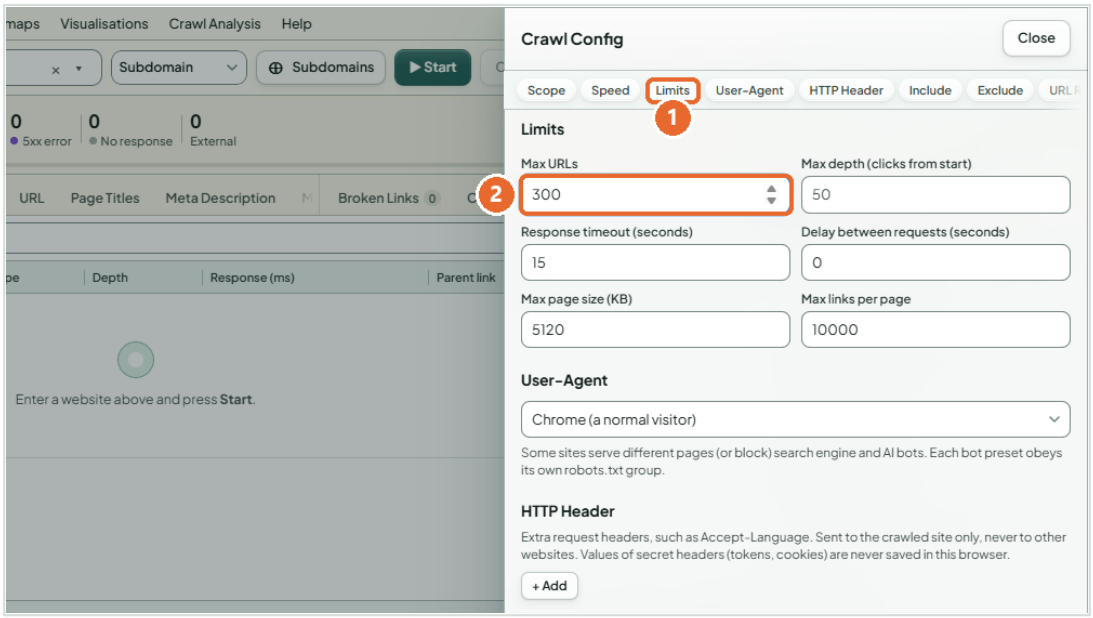
1. Type the site address in **Enter URL to spider**, for example *https://aristasystems.in*.
2. Keep **Mode > Spider** to follow every link from that page. **List** checks only URLs you paste or upload; **SERP** checks titles and descriptions without crawling; **Compare** compares two saved crawls.
3. Keep the scope on **Subdomain** (the start host only). **Subfolder** stays in one folder, **All Subdomains** also crawls shop., blog. and the like.



Tip Not sure which subdomains exist? **Subdomains** next to the scope finds them and says why each one is or is not crawled.

3. Set the few options most people need

1. Click **Options**. The **Crawl Config** panel opens; the buttons along its top jump to each section.
2. Under **Limits**, set **Max URLs**: 300 is a quick first look, 0 means no limit.

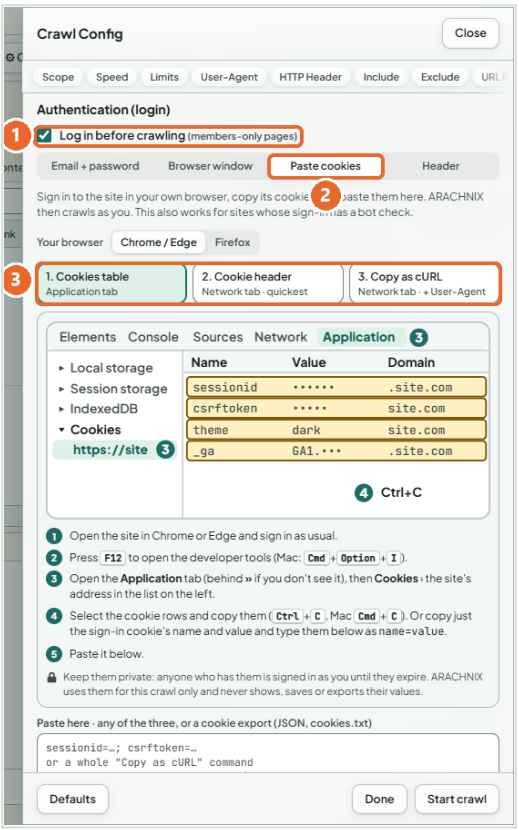


Tip The Options button then shows your limit (for example **max 300**), so you can check it before you start.

JavaScript sites and members-only sites

For sites built with React, Next.js or Vue, tick **Rendering > Render every page in Chrome** in Options. It is slower (about 2-3 seconds a page) but sees what visitors see. For pages behind a login:

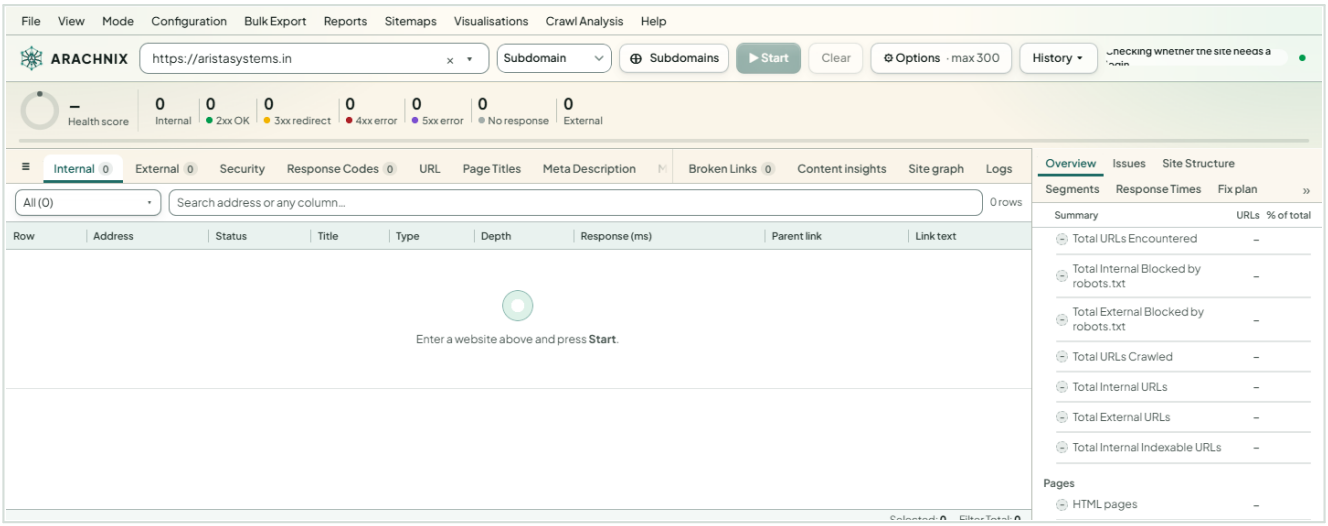
1. Open **Authentication (login)** and tick **Log in before crawling**.
2. Pick a method: **Email + password**, **Browser window** (you sign in yourself in a live window; two-factor works), **Paste cookies** or **Header**.
3. **Paste cookies** shows a step-by-step guide for Chrome / Edge and Firefox: sign in with your own browser, copy the cookies, paste them, then test. This also works when the sign-in has a bot check (CAPTCHA).

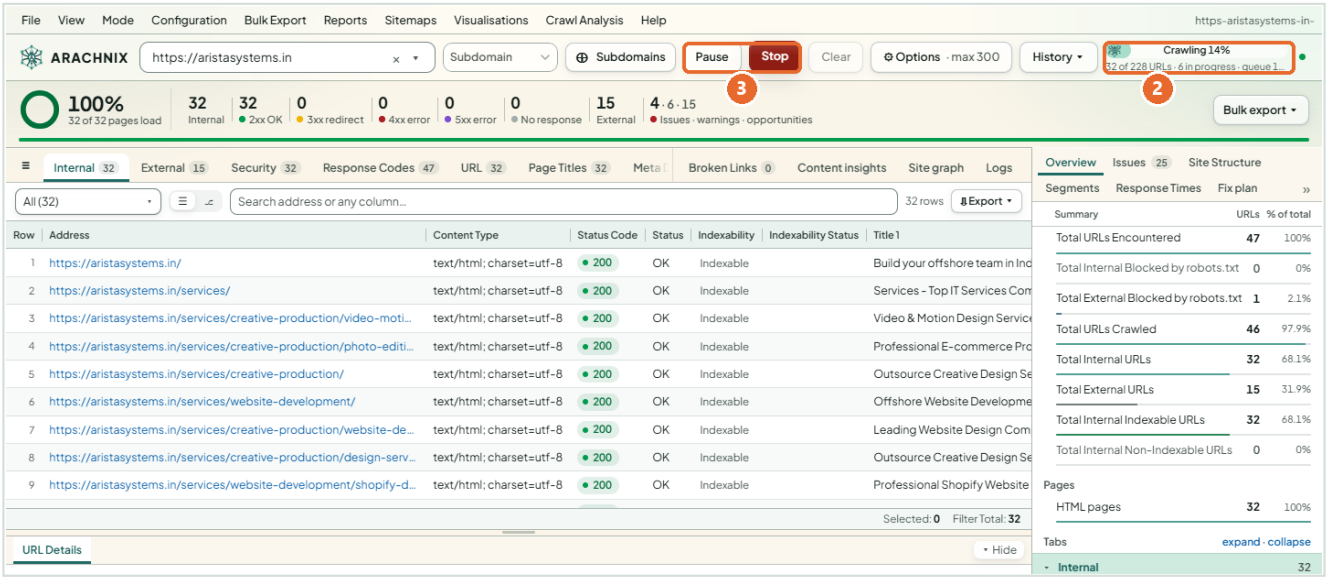


Tip Cookies and passwords are secrets: never paste them into a ticket, a chat or a screenshot. If a site shows a bot check, ARACHNIX never tries to solve it; it tells you what to do instead (see the FAQ).

4. Start the crawl and watch it run

1. Press **Start** (or **Start crawl** at the bottom of Options). The ARACHNIX spider animates while the crawl starts.
2. The status at the top right shows the progress (for example **Crawling 9%**) and the URLs done so far; rows fill the grid as pages are found.
3. **Pause** holds the crawl, **Stop** ends it early. Everything found so far is kept.





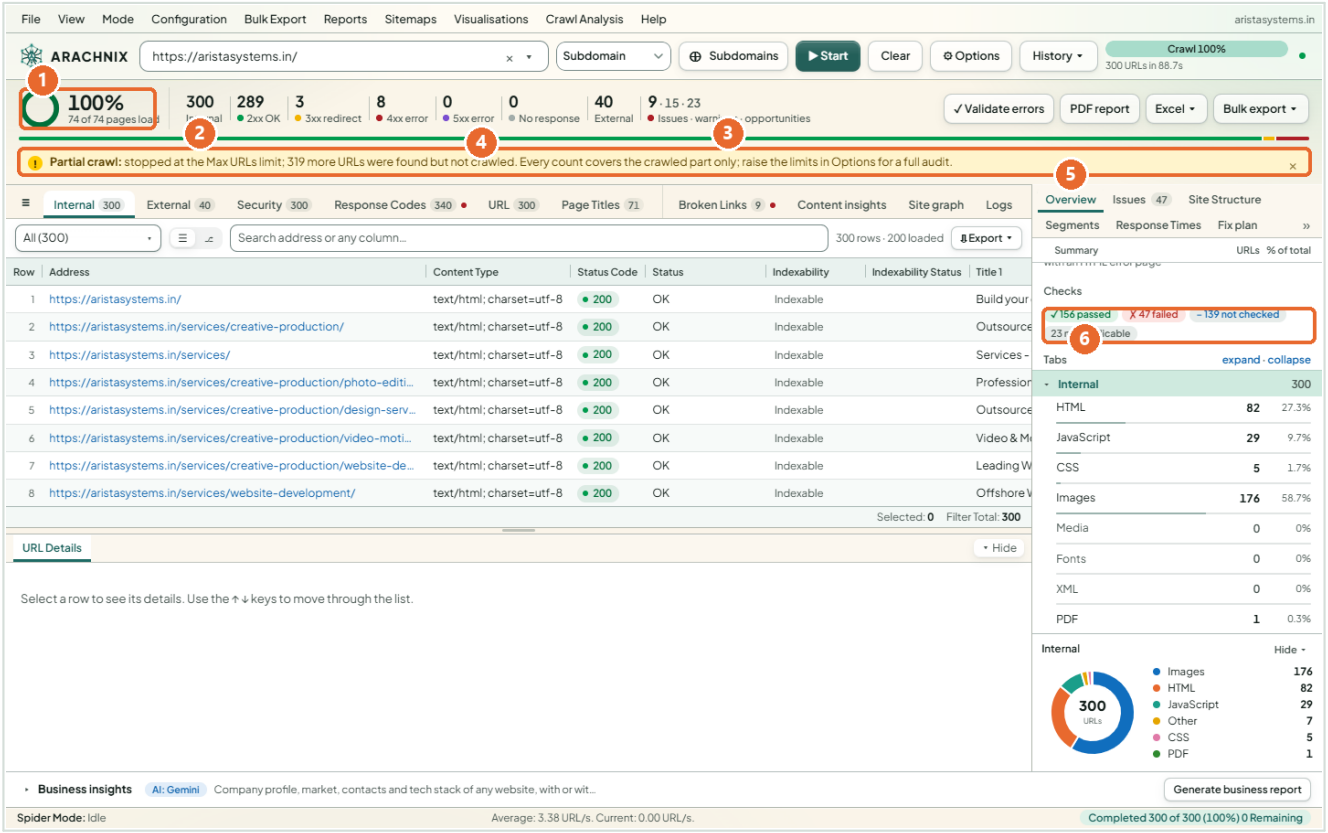
Tip You can close the browser tab: the crawl keeps running on the server. Open ARACHNIX again to see it.

Read the results

When the crawl ends, the screen shows the whole site at a glance.

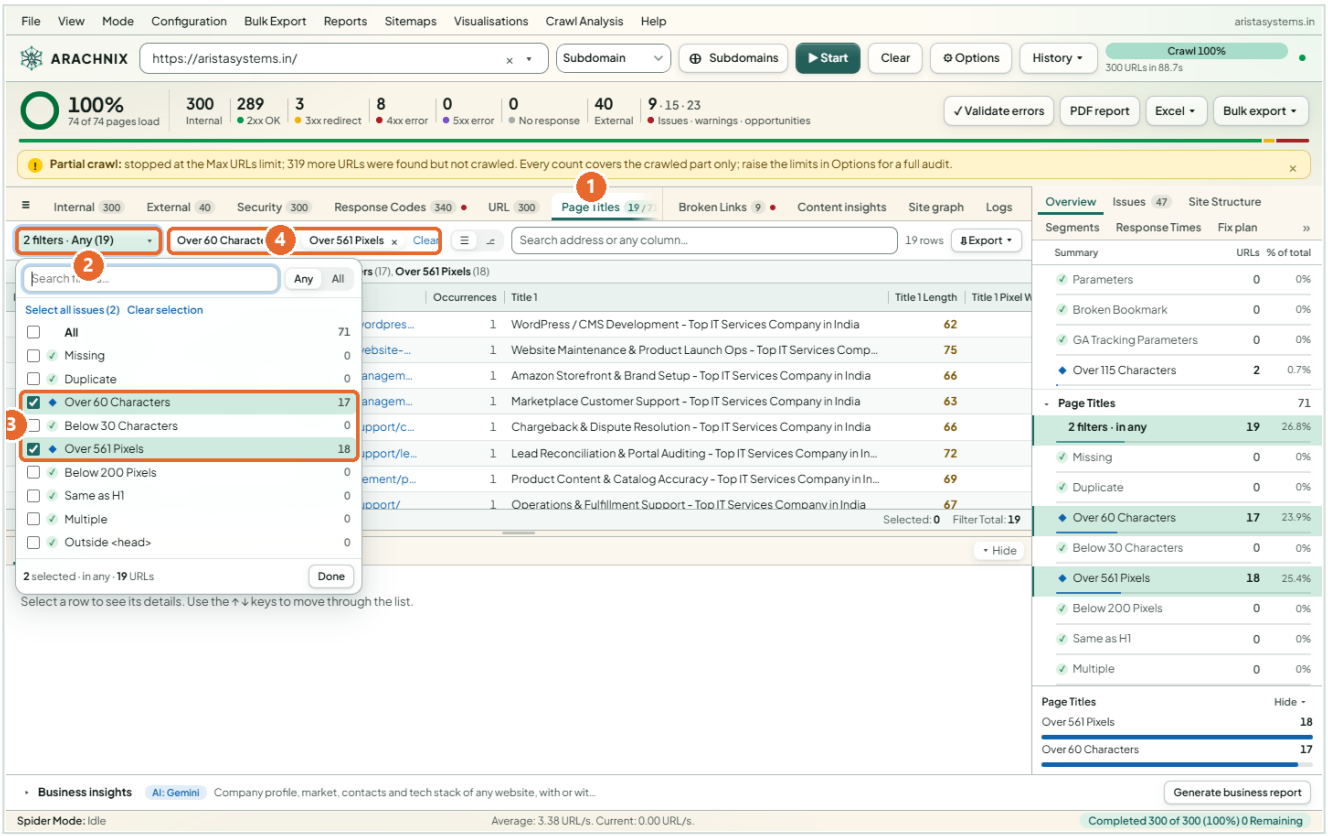
5. The KPI strip and the Overview

1. **Health score**: the share of pages that load without errors.
2. The counts **Internal**, **2xx OK**, **3xx redirect**, **4xx error**, **5xx error**, **No response** and **External**. Each URL is counted once, by its HTTP status, so the numbers always add up.
3. **Issues · warnings · opportunities**: how many SEO checks found problems.
4. A yellow note says when the crawl stopped early (here: at the Max URLs limit).
5. The **Overview** panel lists every tab and filter with its URL count. Click a line to show those URLs.
6. **Checks**: how many checks passed, failed or were not checked (for example, checks that need Chrome rendering).



6. Tabs, filters and search

1. Pick a tab: **Internal**, **External**, **Security**, **Response Codes**, **URL**, **Page Titles** … The ≡ button at the left of the tabs lists all of them.
2. Open the filter box (it shows **All** at first) and pick a filter, such as **Over 60 Characters**.
3. Tick several filters at once. **Any** shows URLs in any of them, **All** only URLs in every one; counts are always distinct URLs.
4. The picked filters show as chips: **×** removes one, **Clear** removes all. Type in **Search address or any column…** to narrow the rows.



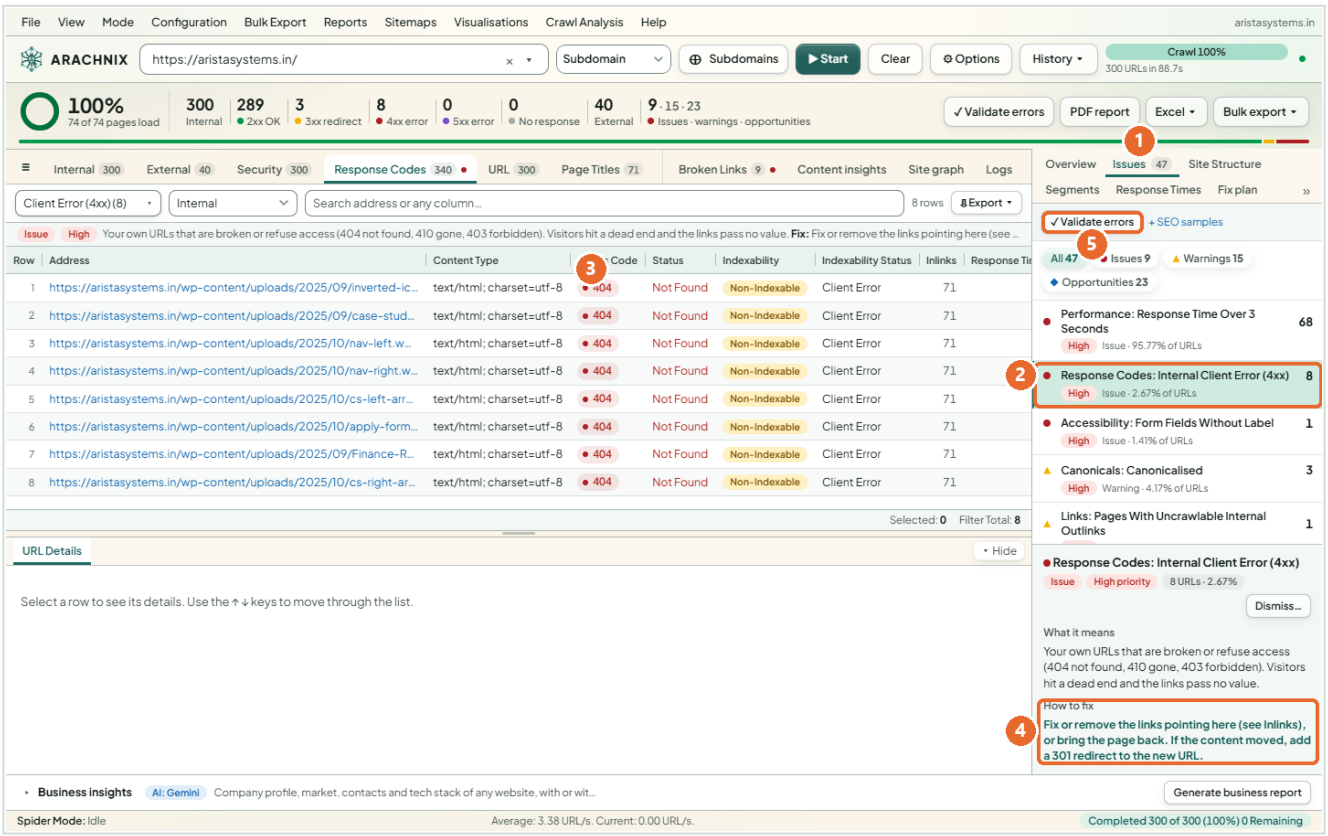
Tip Press **/** to jump to the search box. Click a column header to sort.

Find and fix issues

ARACHNIX ranks problems by priority and says how to fix each one.

7. The Issues panel

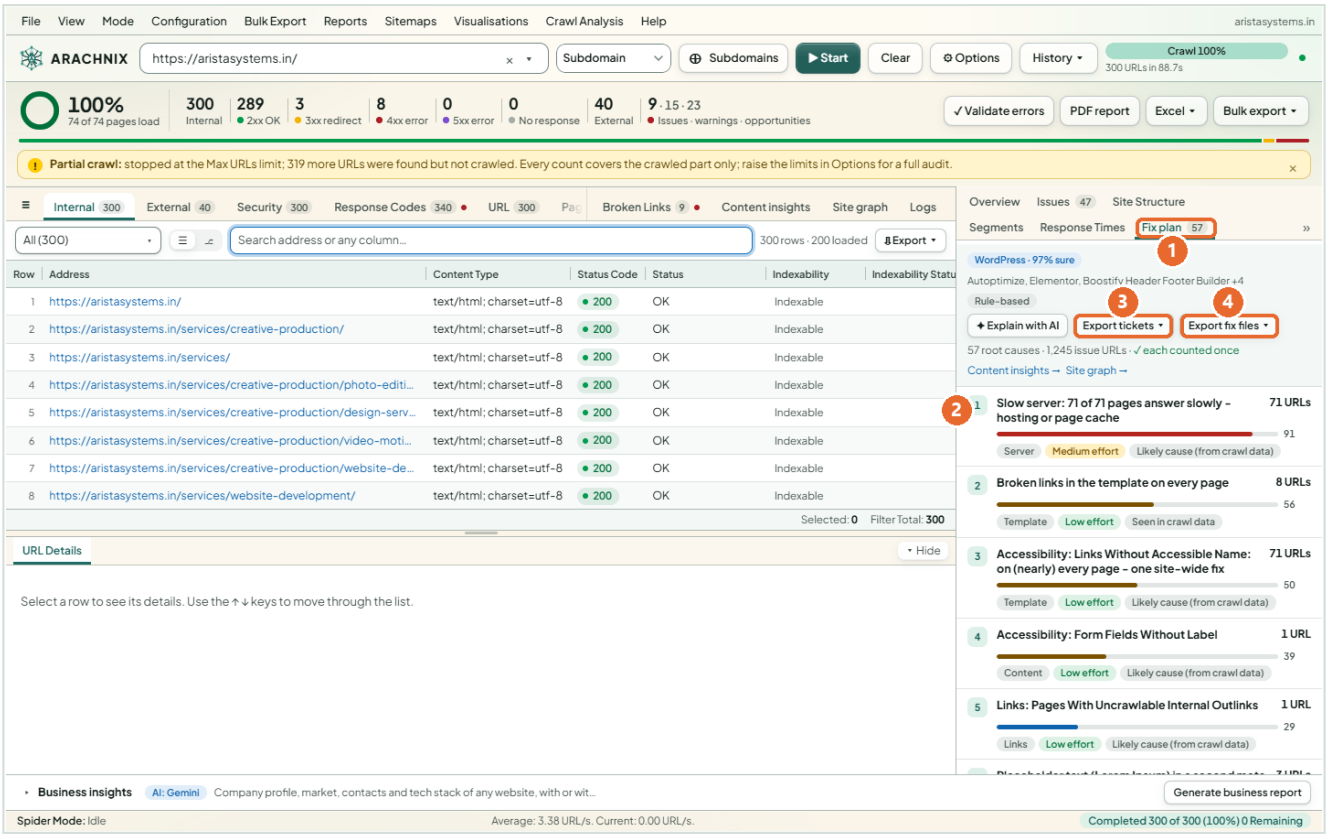
1. Click **Issues** in the right panel. Each line shows the issue, its priority (**High**, **Medium**, **Low**) and its URL count.
2. Click an issue.
3. The grid shows exactly those URLs.
4. **What it means** and **How to fix** appear under the list. **Dismiss…** marks an issue as fine for this site, with a note.
5. **Validate errors** re-checks every broken URL live (3 tries each), so you only report errors that are real.



Tip The chips **Issues**, **Warnings** and **Opportunities** filter the list.

The Fix plan: what to fix first

1. Click **Fix plan** in the right panel.
2. Issues are grouped by root cause, in fix-first order: one template fix often clears hundreds of URLs. Each card shows the URLs, the effort and the evidence.
3. **Export tickets**: one developer ticket per root cause (CSV, Jira import, Markdown, or a ZIP with screenshots).
4. **Export fix files**: ready-to-import fixes for Yoast, Rank Math, Shopify, .htaccess, Next.js or CSV.



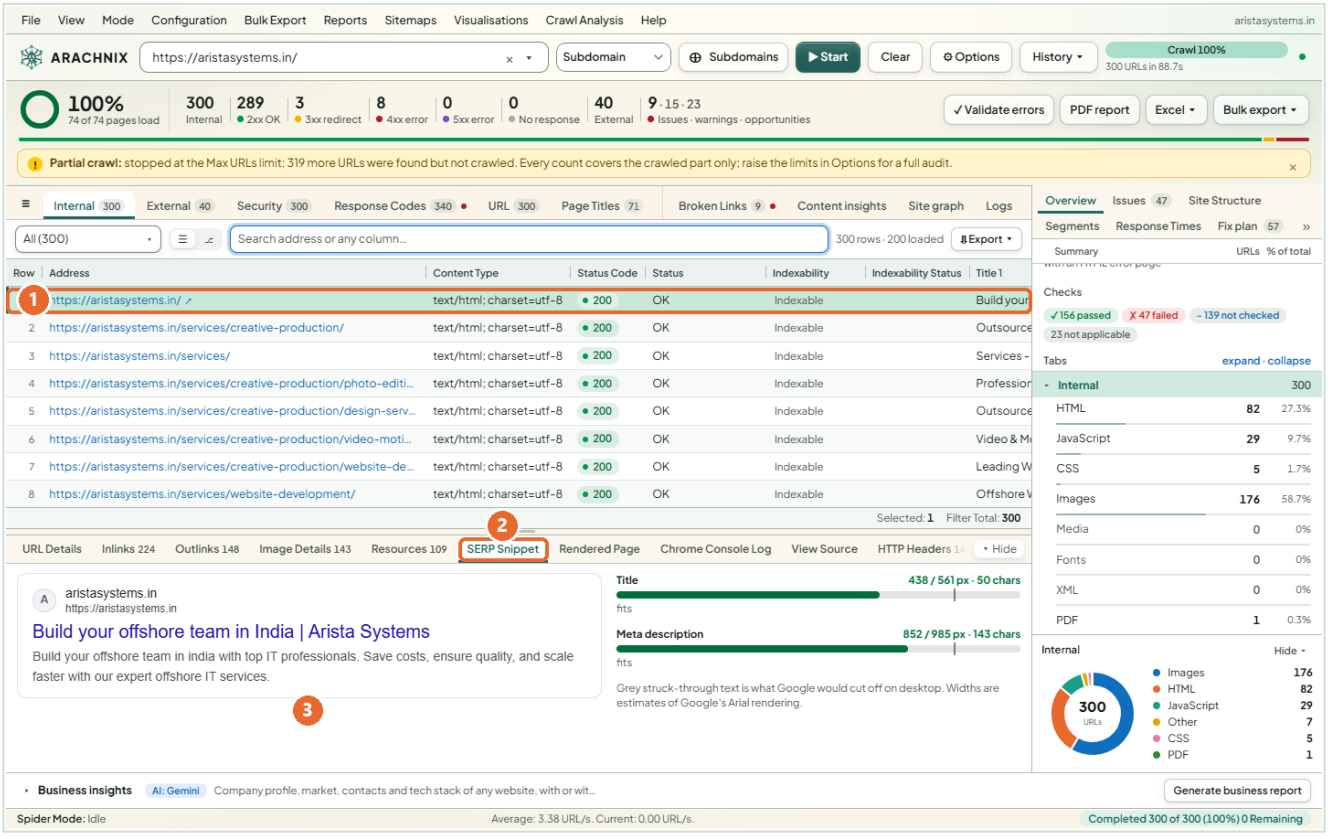
Tip The platform (here WordPress) is detected from the site, so the fix steps name the right plugin or setting.

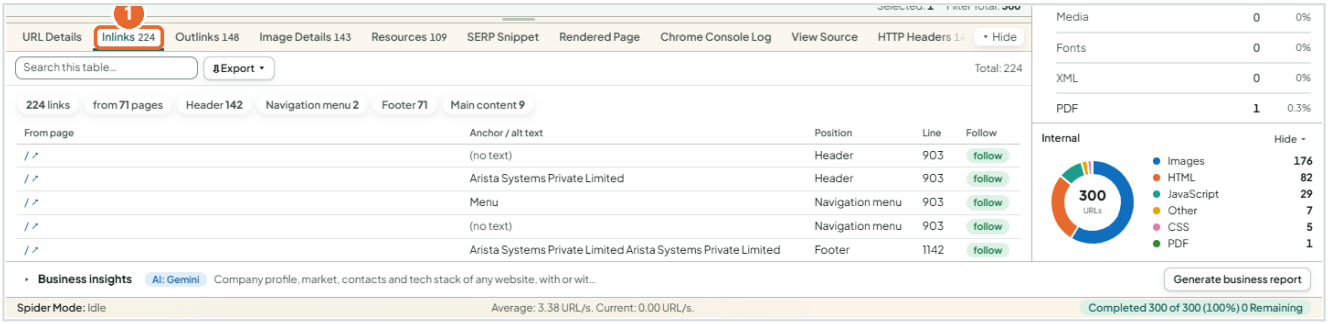
Look at one URL

Click any row: the bottom pane shows everything about that URL.

8. The URL details pane

1. Click a row in the grid (or move with the arrow keys).
2. Pick a tab in the bottom pane: **URL Details**, **Inlinks**, **Outlinks**, **Image Details**, **Resources**, **SERP Snippet**, **Rendered Page**, **View Source**, **HTTP Headers**, **Issues**, **Why & Fix** ...
3. **SERP Snippet** previews the Google result and measures the title and description in pixels.

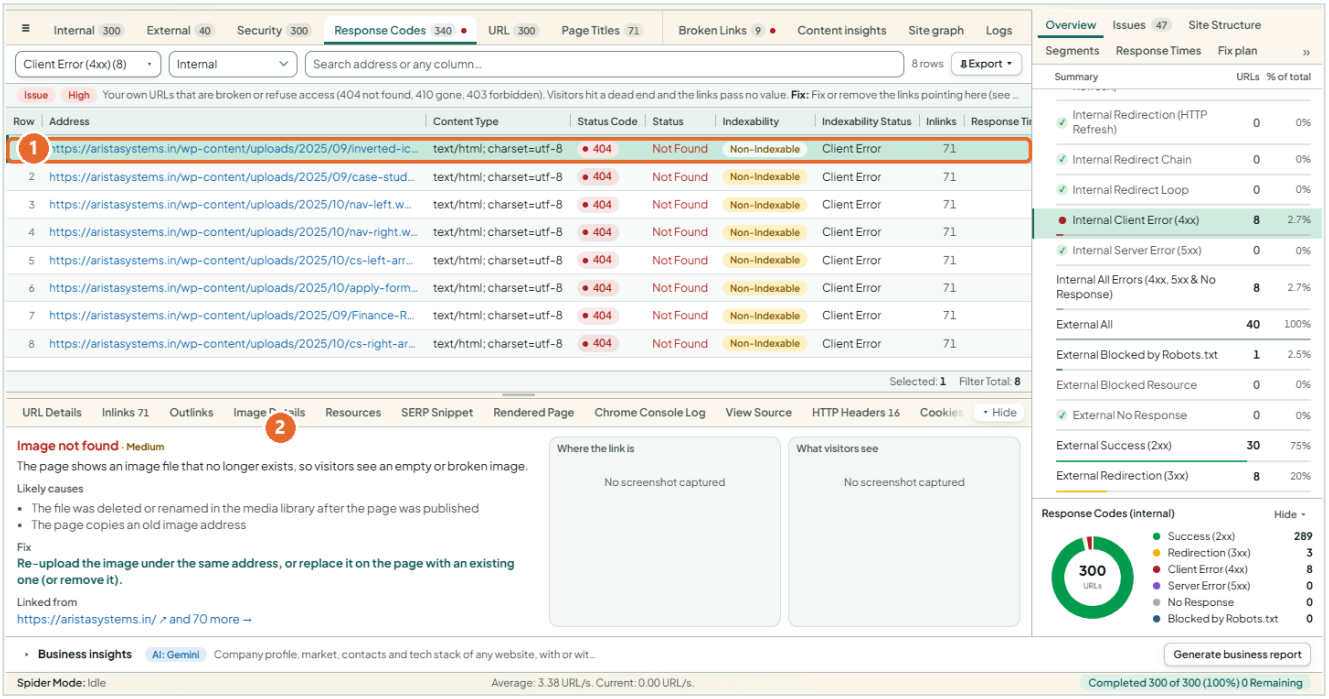


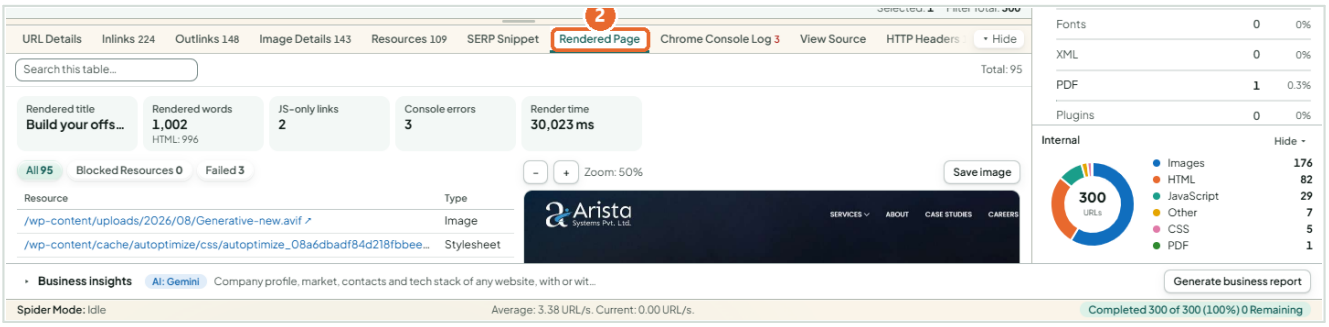


Inlinks: every page that links here, with the anchor text and where the link sits (header, menu, footer, content).

Why a URL is broken, and what the page looks like

1. Select a broken URL (for example from the 4xx issue). **Why & Fix** gives the likely cause, the fix and the pages that link to it.
2. **Rendered Page** shows the page as Chrome draws it, with its resources. If the crawl did not render pages, press **Render this page now**.





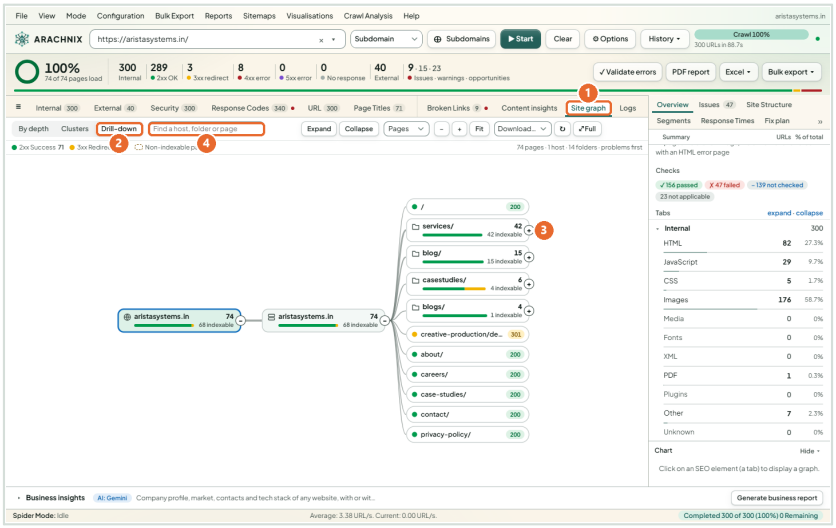
Tip **HTTP Headers** shows the server's answer, with green ticks for the security headers that are present.

Visualise the site

See how the site hangs together: folders, depth and links.

9. Site graph and drill-down

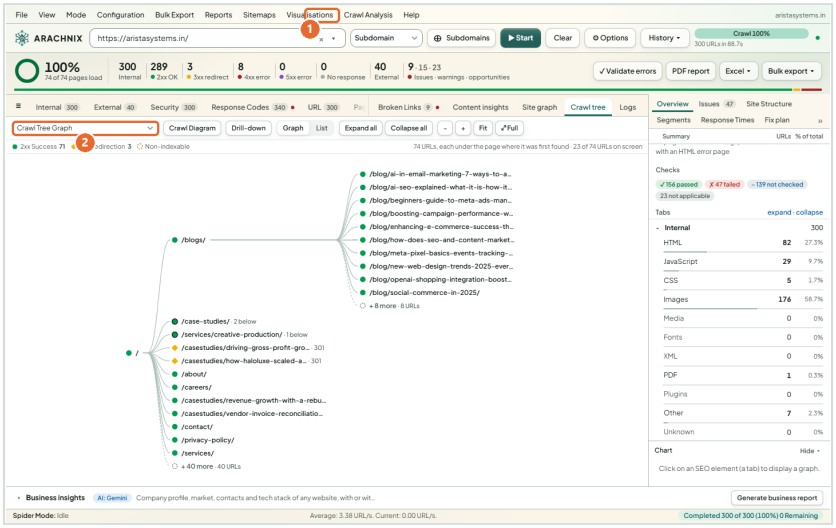
1. Click the **Site graph** tab.
2. Choose **Drill-down** to open the site level by level: domain, host, folders, pages.
3. Click **+** on a folder to open it. The bar shows how many pages are indexable; the colours show the status.
4. Type in **Find a host, folder or page** to jump to one.



Tip **By depth** lays pages out by clicks from the start page; **Clusters** groups pages that link to each other.

Crawl tree and other diagrams

1. Open the **Visualisations** menu: **Crawl Tree Graph**, **Directory Tree Graph**, **Force-Directed Crawl Diagram**, **Drill-down Tree** and two word clouds.
2. Switch diagrams with the list at the top left. **Graph** / **List** changes the view; **Expand all** opens every branch.



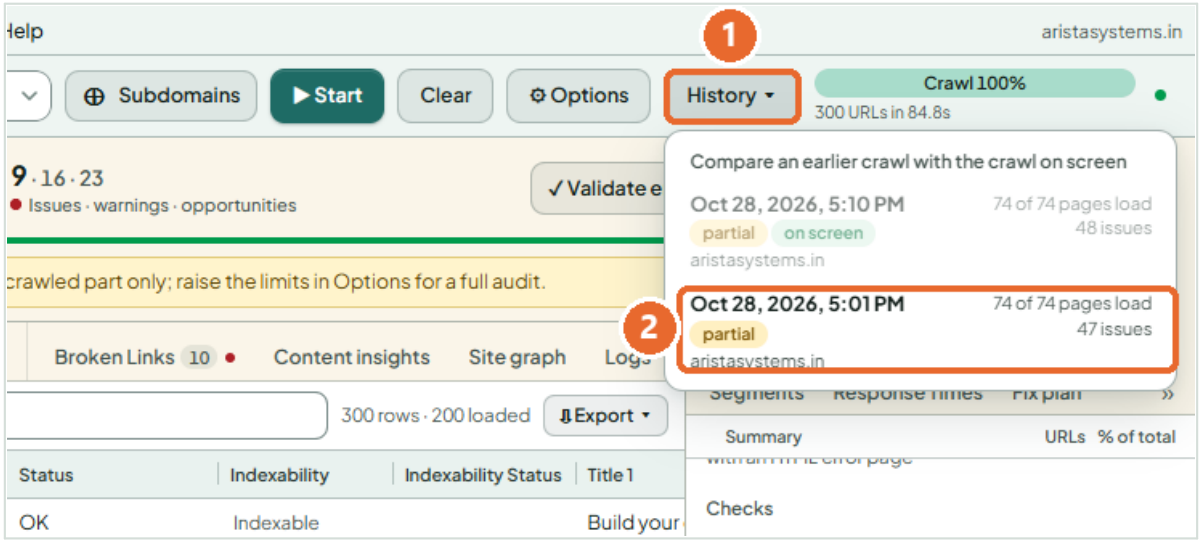
Tip Each page sits under the page where it was first found: long chains show pages that are hard to reach.

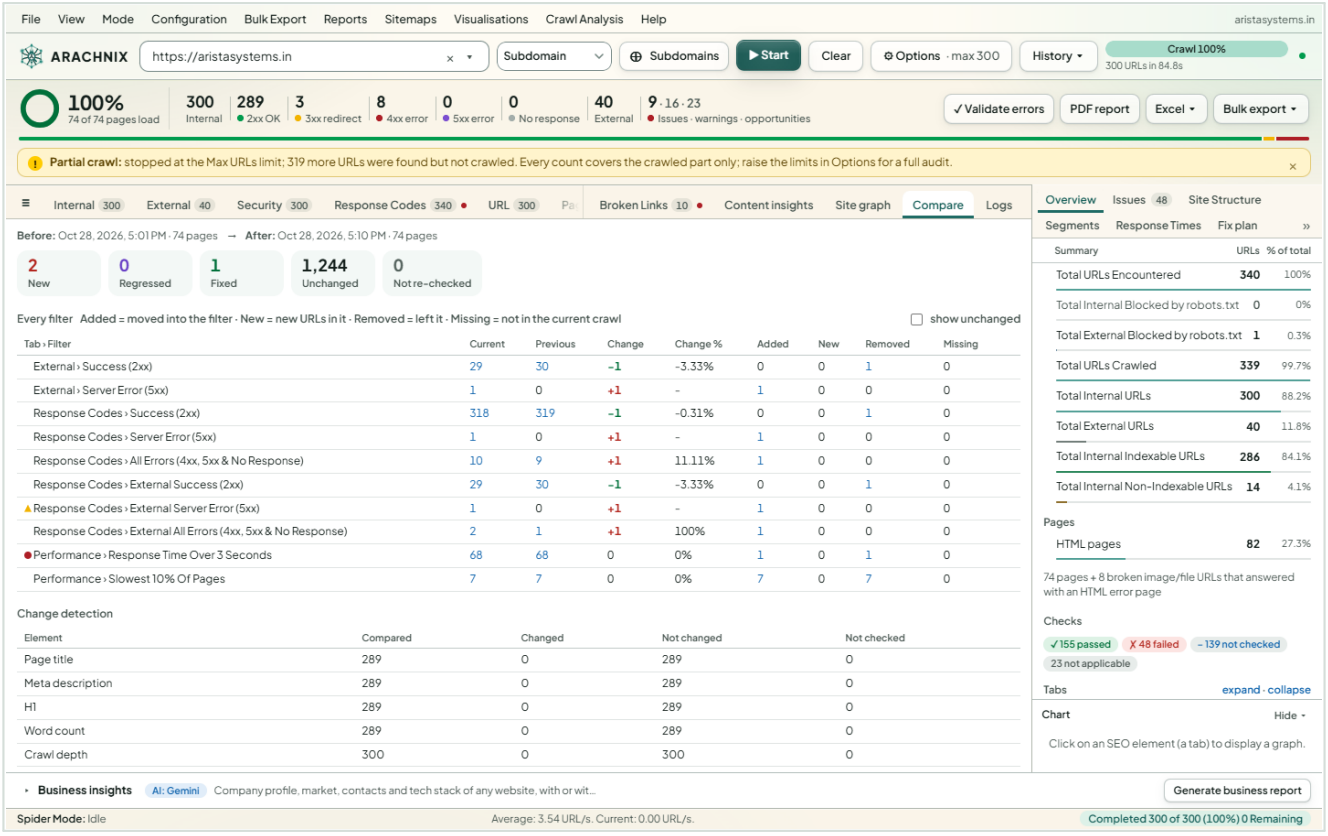
Compare crawls

Crawl the site again later and see what changed. Every finished crawl is saved, so there is nothing to set up.

10. Compare an earlier crawl with the crawl on screen

1. Click **History**.
2. Pick the earlier crawl of the same site. ARACHNIX opens the comparison.





Each filter shows **Added**, **New**, **Removed** and **Missing** URLs, and change detection lists pages whose title, description, H1, word count, depth, inlinks, indexability, status code, canonical, structured data or content changed.

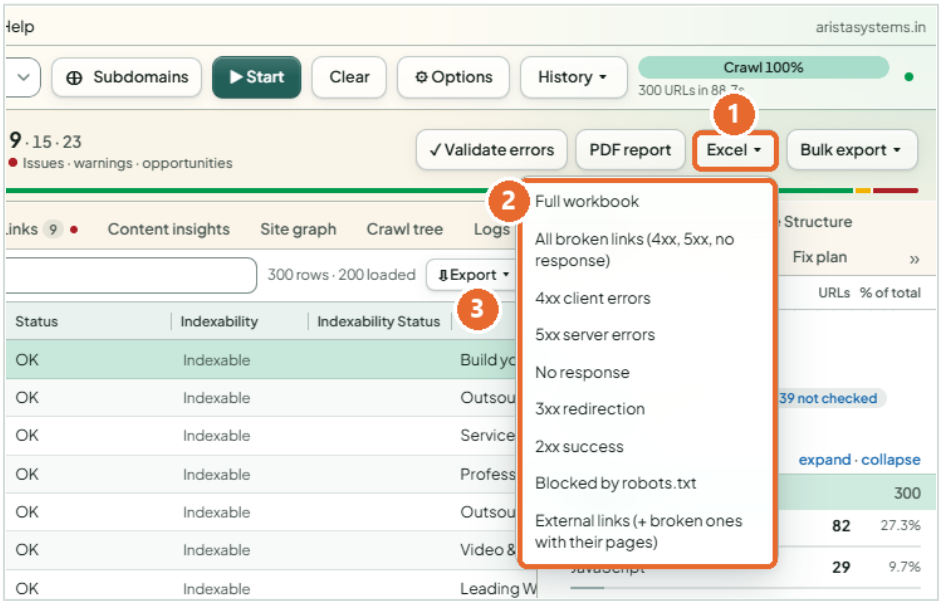
Tip To compare any two saved crawls, use **Mode > Compare** or **File > Crawls...**, tick two crawls and press **Compare**. If a deciding setting changed between them (for example the scope), ARACHNIX says the crawls are not comparable.

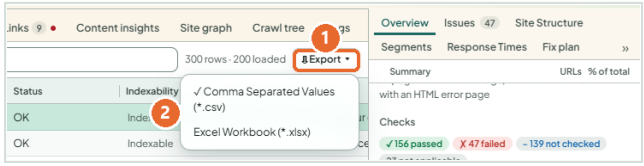
Export and share

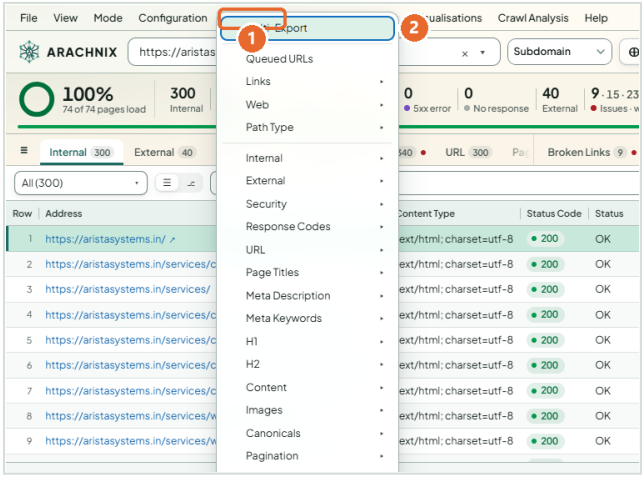
Excel for the team, PDF for clients and managers.

11. Excel, CSV and bulk exports

1. **Excel** (top right):
2. **Full workbook** has every tab in one file; the other entries are ready-made workbooks such as all broken links.
3. Each entry is one click and downloads straight away.



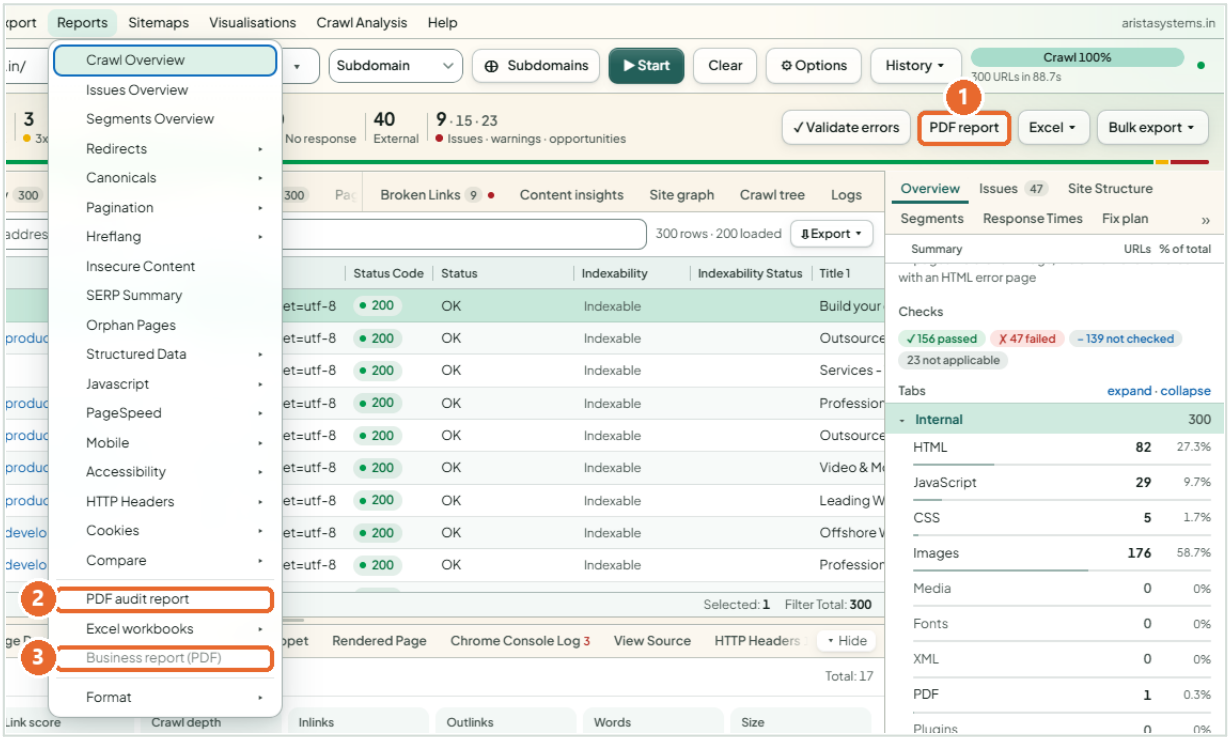




Left: **Export** above the grid downloads exactly what is on screen (tab, filters, search) as CSV or Excel. Right: the **Bulk Export** menu: all inlinks, all issues, redirect chains and more, by tab.

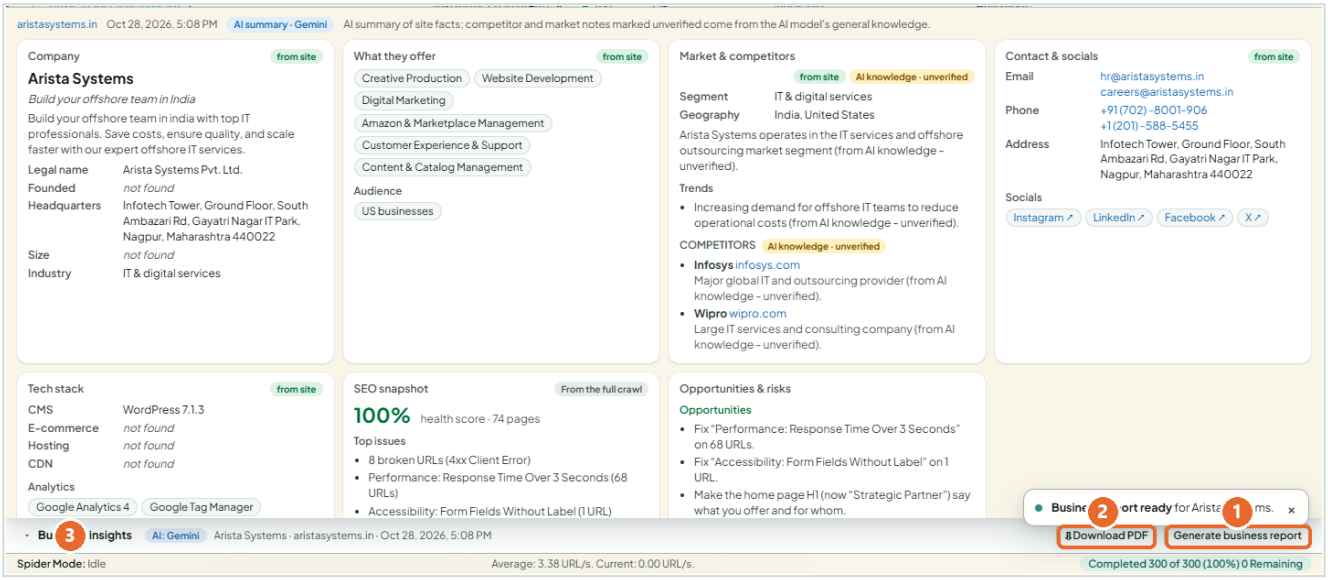
12. PDF reports

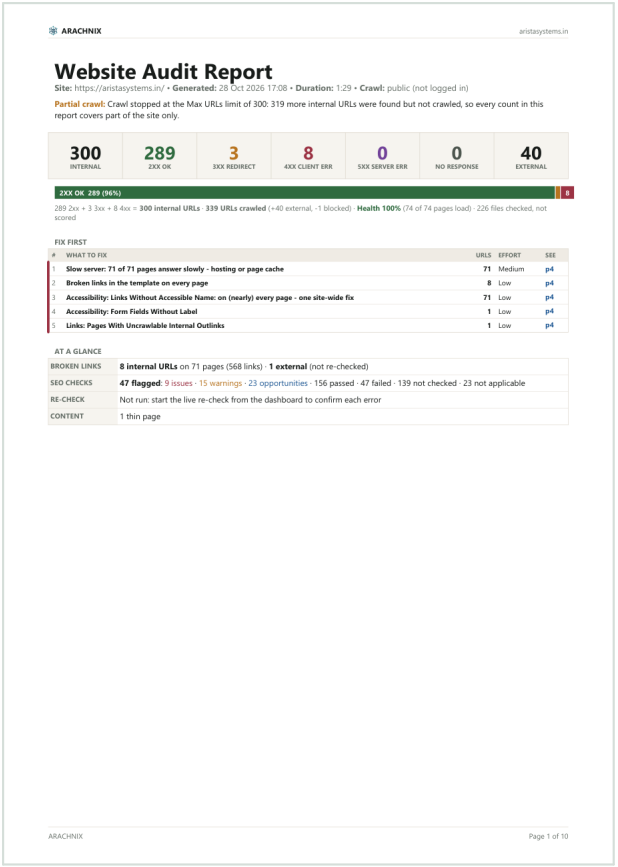
1. **PDF report** (top right, or **Reports > PDF audit report**) builds the Website Audit Report: a compact, client-ready PDF with the counts, what to fix first and the evidence. Larger sites take a minute while it prepares the pictures.
2. **Reports > Excel workbooks** has the same workbooks as the Excel button.
3. **Business report (PDF)** is ready once a business report exists (next page).

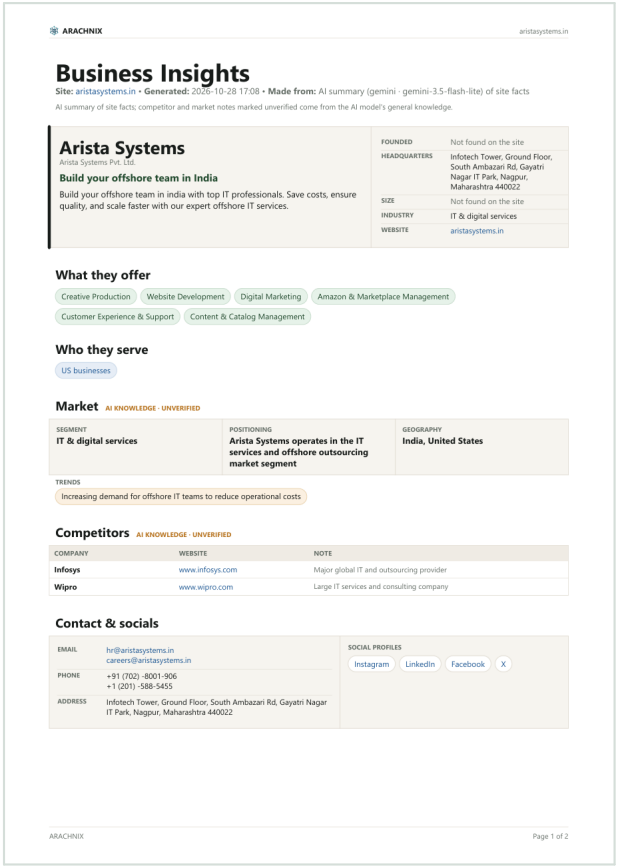


Business insights

1. At the bottom of the screen, press **Generate business report**. It researches the company behind the site: what it offers, its market, competitors, contacts and tech stack.
2. When it is ready, **Download PDF** saves the Business Insights PDF.
3. **Business insights** opens or closes the panel. Facts come from the site; market and competitor notes are marked *AI knowledge · unverified*.







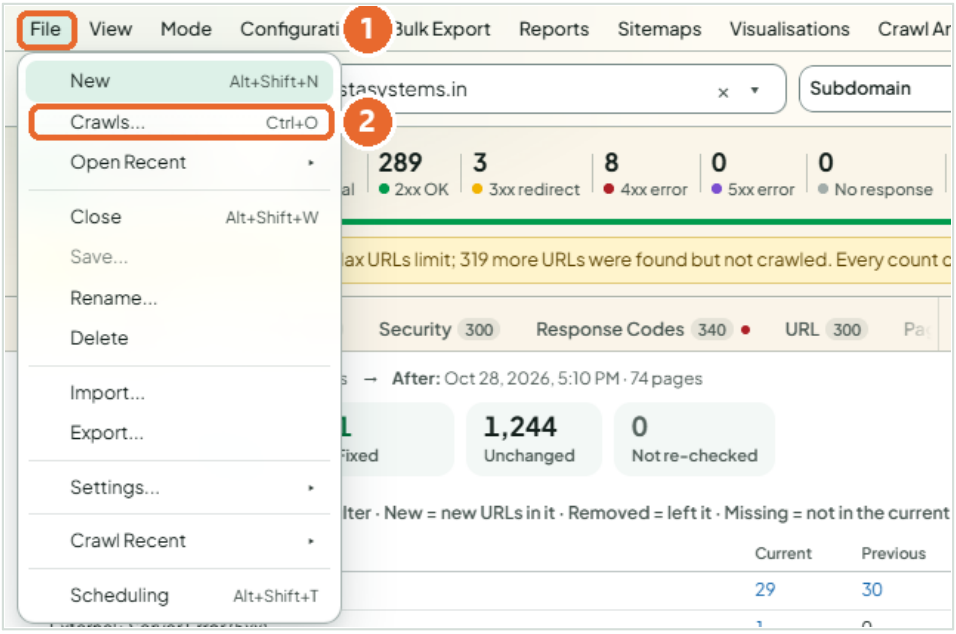
First pages: the Website Audit Report (left) and the Business Insights PDF (right).

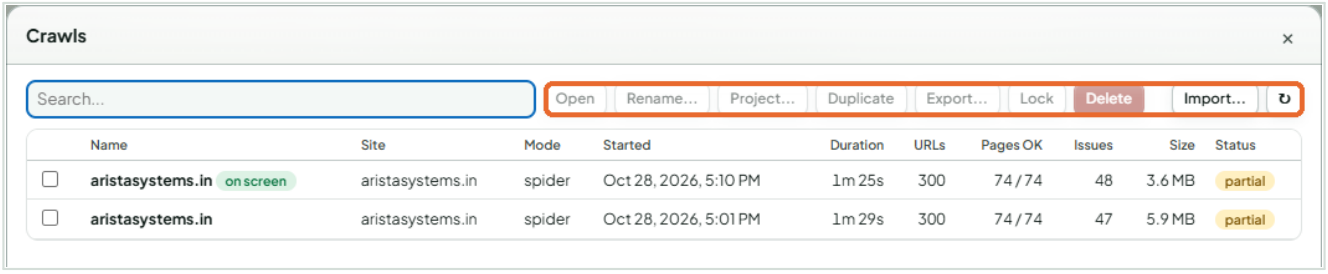
Saved crawls

Every finished crawl is saved on the server for the whole team.

13. Open, rename and manage saved crawls

1. Open **File**.
2. **Crawls…** (Ctrl+O) lists every saved crawl. From there you can open, rename, lock, export, import or delete one, or tick two and compare them. **Open Recent** reopens a recent crawl.





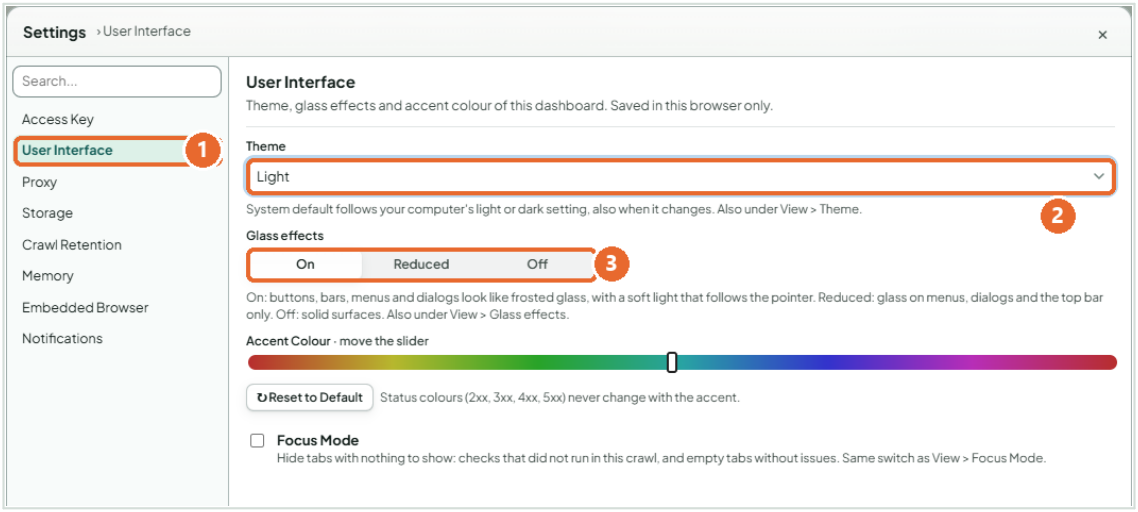
Tip **Clear** takes the crawl off the screen for everyone; the crawl stays saved under File > Crawls. To crawl another site you do not need to clear: type the new address and press Start.

Settings: theme and glass

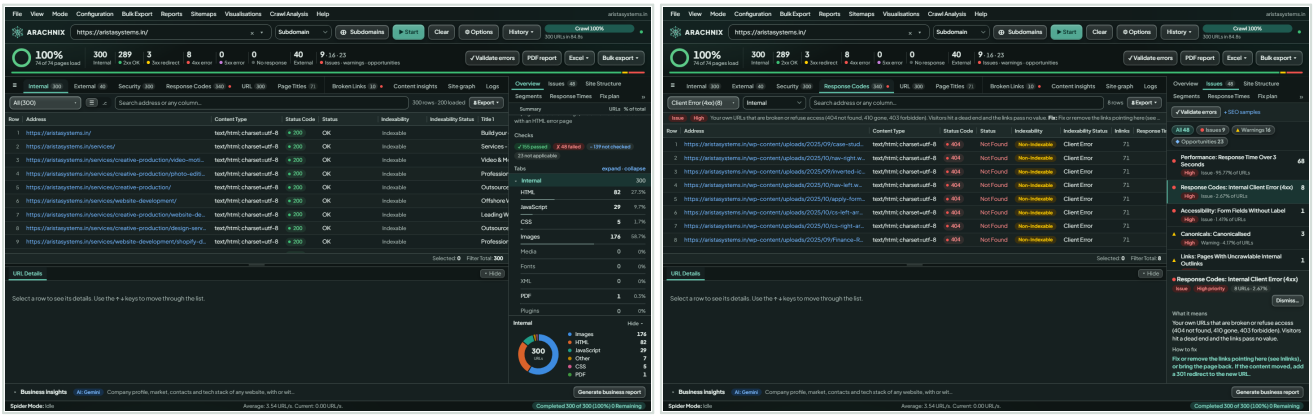
Choose how ARACHNIX looks. These choices are saved in your browser only.

14. Theme and glass effects

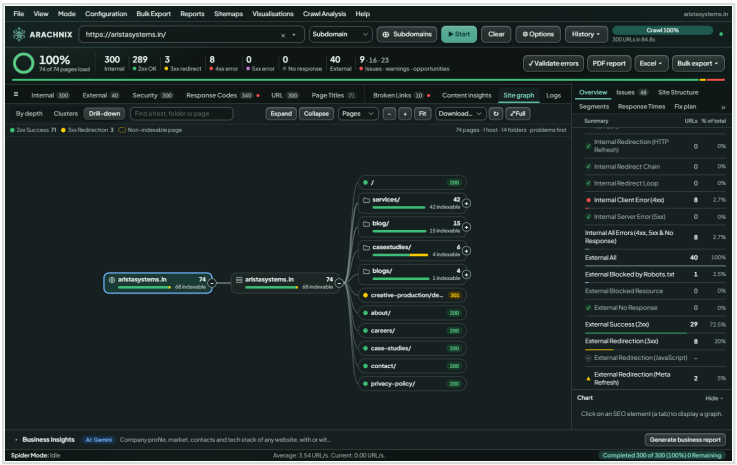
1. Open **File > Settings...** (Ctrl+,) and pick **User Interface**.
2. **Theme**: **Light**, **Dark** or **System default** (follows your computer).
3. **Glass effects**: **On** (frosted glass and a soft light under the pointer), **Reduced** (glass on menus and dialogs only) or **Off** (solid). Press **OK** to keep the change.

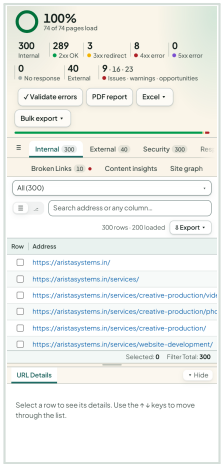


Tip Quicker: **View > Theme** and **View > Glass effects** change it straight from the menu.



The dark theme: results with the Overview (left) and an issue with its fix (right).





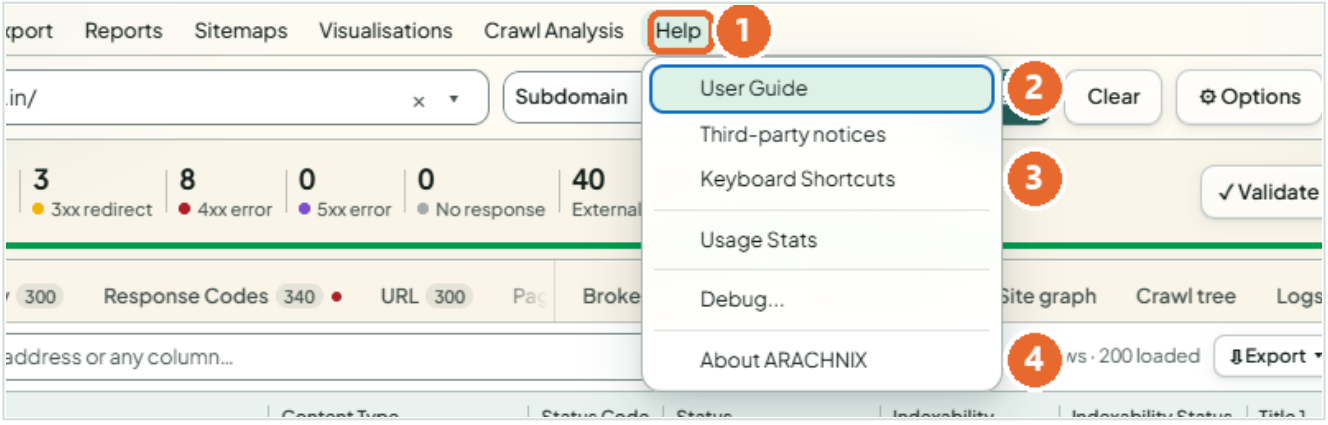
Left: the drill-down site graph in the dark theme. Right: ARACHNIX on a phone: the KPI strip, buttons and grid stack in one column.

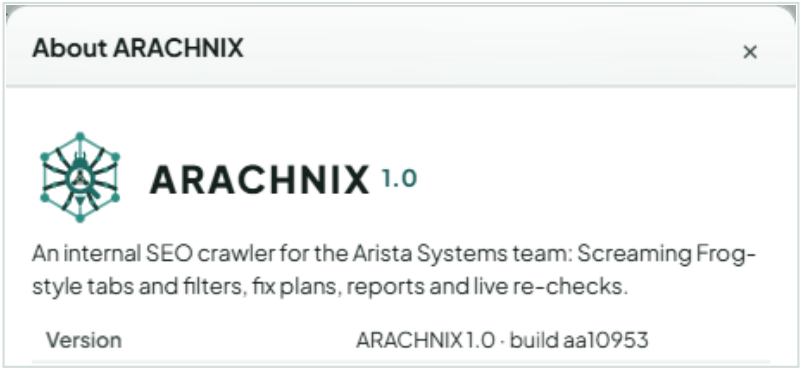
Help

Answers inside the app.

15. The Help menu

1. Open **Help**.
2. **User Guide**: the short guide inside the app.
3. **Keyboard Shortcuts**: every key in one list.
4. **About ARACHNIX**: the version (ARACHNIX 1.0) and the server details to quote when you ask for help.





Tip Something looks wrong? **Help > Debug...** shows the server details and the crawl log (no secrets) and can download them as a file to send to the team that runs ARACHNIX.

Quick reference

Where things are	
Start a crawl	Address box, then **Start** (top bar)
Crawl settings	**Options** or **Configuration > Crawl Config** (Ctrl+;)
Crawl a list of URLs	**Mode > List**, then **Upload**
Sign in to a private site	Options > **Authentication (login)**
All tabs	≡ at the left of the tab bar
Issues, Fix plan	Right panel: **Issues**, **Fix plan**
One URL in detail	Click a row; bottom pane tabs
Re-check broken URLs	**Validate errors** (top right)
Diagrams	**Site graph** tab, **Visualisations** menu
Compare crawls	**History**, or **Mode > Compare**
Excel / CSV	**Excel**, grid **Export**, **Bulk Export** menu
PDF reports	**PDF report**; **Generate business report** (bottom)
Saved crawls	**File > Crawls...** (Ctrl+O)
Scheduled crawls	**File > Scheduling** (Alt+Shift+T)
Theme, glass	**View > Theme**, **View > Glass effects**

Common filters (tab > filter)	
Broken links	Response Codes > **Internal Client Error (4xx)**
Server errors	Response Codes > **Internal Server Error (5xx)**
Redirects	Response Codes > **Internal Redirection (3xx)**
Long titles	Page Titles > **Over 60 Characters**
Missing descriptions	Meta Description > **Missing**
Missing H1	H1 > **Missing**
Images without alt text	Images > **Missing Alt Text**
Duplicate pages	Content > **Exact Duplicates**, **Near Duplicates**
Pages not in the sitemap	Sitemaps > **URLs not in Sitemap**
Blocked from Google	Directives > **Noindex**; Response Codes > **Blocked by Robots.txt**

Keyboard keys (Help > Keyboard Shortcuts)	
/	Search the grid
↑ ↓, Page Up / Down	Move through the grid
Space	Tick a row (several rows)
Enter	Details of the selected row
Esc	Close a menu or dialog
Ctrl+O	File > Crawls
Ctrl+,	File > Settings
Ctrl+;	Crawl Config
Alt+Shift+N / W / T	New / Close / Scheduling

FAQ

My site needs a login.

Options > **Authentication (login)** > **Log in before crawling**. Use **Email + password** for a normal login form, **Browser window** for two-factor or single sign-on, or **Paste cookies** when the sign-in has a bot check. ARACHNIX never clicks sign-out or links that change data.

The site shows a bot check or blocks the crawler.

ARACHNIX does not try to solve CAPTCHAs. When it sees a bot wall it shows what to do: sign in with **Paste cookies** or **Browser window**, slow the crawl down (Options > **Speed**), or ask the site owner to allow the crawler. The **AI Crawlers** tab shows what Googlebot and AI crawlers get.

The crawl stopped early.

Read the yellow note under the KPI strip. Usually the **Max URLs** or **Max depth** limit was reached (raise it in Options > **Limits**), or someone pressed **Stop**. Every count then covers only the crawled part.

The numbers in the PDF differ from the grid.

They come from the same crawl, so they match when you compare like with like: the PDF counts internal URLs by HTTP status, as the KPI strip does. The grid shows only the current tab, filters and search; clear them (**All**) to see every URL. Issues your team dismissed are left out of both the PDF and the issue counts.

Why do some checks say "not checked"?

They need something this crawl did not have, for example **Render every page in Chrome** (accessibility, JavaScript) or a Google connection (Search Console, GA4, PageSpeed) under **Configuration > API Access**. ARACHNIX never shows a misleading zero.

Is a 404 really broken?

Press **Validate errors**: each broken URL is re-checked live three times and marked confirmed, intermittent or already fixed.

Can I run crawls automatically?

Yes: **File > Scheduling** runs a crawl daily, weekly or monthly and can email when it finishes.

Does ARACHNIX work on a phone?

Yes, the dashboard fits a phone screen. For long audits a computer is easier.

More help Need more detail on a check? Click it in the **Issues** panel (What it means, How to fix), or open **Why & Fix** for a URL.